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**NIAID/USAMRIID Coordinating Meeting Minutes:
11 March 2002**

- A meeting between NIAID and USAMRIID/USAMRMC Program Managers was held at USAMRIID on 11 March 2002 (see enclosure).
- An overview of the USAMRIID program was provided by LTC Korch. It included a comparison of the similarities and the differences in the DOD vs. HHS program objectives.
- Dr. Heilman outlined the major goals of the NIH Bioterrorism Response Program
 - Reagent repository
 - Development of scientific expertise with specific threat agents
 - Regional centers of excellence
 - Emphasize a broader definition of what constitutes a threat agent
 - Utilize large funding stream to simultaneously support multiple efforts
- Areas of potential collaboration were discussed. Dr. Fauci emphasized the importance of making a quick win that can show the public the value added by a NIAID-USAMRIID collaboration. Goal will be to ensure that efforts of NIAID satisfy requirements of the DOD program as indicated in their Operational Requirements Document (ORD).
 - rPA vaccine (highest priority for both NIAID and DOD)
 - Work on this effort is proceeding
 - NIAID supporting Phase I clinical trial
 - Long-term rate limiting step to licensure is a potency assay
 - USAMRIID working on mouse immunogenicity model
 - Orthopoxvirus therapeutics
 - Leverage NIAID funded contract to screen antivirals
 - Contractors have BSL-3 capability
 - Proposed transfer of Monkeypox virus from USAMRIID to contractors to use in screening program
 - Diagnostics
 - Weak point for NIAID
 - NIAID has been communicating with DARPA
 - USAMRIID weak in microarray
 - Leverage existing NIAID contract with TIGR to do array work
 - Reagent Repository
 - USAMRIID has many strains and reagents that could be provided
 - NIAID would fund expansion of reagents, including QC, similar to what was done for the AIDS program

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- USAMRIID could leverage repository for their own use
- Animal Testing
 - Animal holding space: major limiting factor
 - Availability of NHPs: another problem
 - USAMRIID
 - Has extensive aerosol capability
 - Established SOPs and animal models that could be leveraged
 - Could be used
 - USAMRIID asked to provide cost estimate for expanded animal holding space to NIAID
 - Alternate models: area of potential investment by NIAID
 - Assays: USAMRIID has established SOPs that could be leveraged by NIAID
- Rift Valley Fever Virus (RVF)
 - NIAID considers it an important pathogen
 - Interested in pursuing further development of the USAMRIID products
 - NIAID requesting assistance in identifying potential international study sites
- Plague Vaccine: potential area of collaboration
- Botulinum neurotoxin
 - NIAID interested in transfer of USAMRIID heptavalent equine product
- Proteomics: NIAID could leverage funding to support large-scale effort and share results/information with USAMRIID
- Clinical Trials: NIAID's existing investment in clinical trial centers could be leveraged by USAMRIID to conduct Phase I studies for their mature vaccine products
- Dr. Heilman emphasized that NIAID is very interested in collaborating with USAMRIID in this effort. Proposed a series of follow-on meetings to discuss details.
- **ACTION ITEMS:**
 - USAMRIID and NIAID will each exchange lists of potential areas of collaboration that they see ([REDACTED] and Heilman)
 - USAMRIID will provide NIAID with a cost estimate for additional animal holding space ([REDACTED])

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- USAMRIID will prepare a set of guidelines to NIAID regarding their ability to accept funding through Interagency Agreements ([REDACTED])
- USAMRIID will provide NIAID a copy of the Requirements document for the rPA vaccine ([REDACTED])